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DEVICE FOR DRILLING CENTERED HOLES

Abstract

Disclosed are tools for creating holes in precise locations for alignment on two different sides of an object, such as a strut or beam. Precise alignment of the holes allows for support of the object using a connecting bolt. Oversized holes can be corrected using an insert with an opening of the proper size. Precisely located holes can also be provided in angled materials, such as angled trusses and beams.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

[0001] Metal truss connector plates are frequently used to secure trusses or timbers in a building. These trusses are often decorative but also provide structural stability. It is oftentimes difficult to drill holes that are centered on metal truss connector plates so that bolts connecting metal truss connector plates on two sides of the trusses are supported by the wood surfaces inside the drilled holes.

SUMMARY

[0002] A tool for boring a final hole in a truss, having a final diameter, that is coaxial with a centerline between a first location on a first side of a truss and a second location on a second side of the truss comprising: a pilot rod that has a diameter that is less than the final diameter; a first template placed on a first side of the truss, and secured to the truss, that provides the first location on the first side of the truss; a second template placed on a second side of the truss, and secured to the truss, that provides the second location on the second side of the truss; a pilot bit secured to a drill that is adapted to create a wobbled hole in the truss between the first location and the second location that is sufficiently large to allow the pilot rod to extend through the wobbled hole from the first location to the second location; a borer mounted coaxially with the pilot rod, the borer having a diameter that is the same as the final diameter, the borer adapted to bore the final hole in the truss that is coaxial with the centerline between the first location and the second location.

[0003] A method of forming a final hole in a truss that is coaxial with a centerline between a first location, on a first side of the truss, and a second location on a second side of the truss comprising: using a first template on the first side of the truss to place at least one opening in the template at the first location on the first side of the truss, and a second template on the second side of the truss to place at least one opening in the second location on the second side of the truss; drilling a first pilot hole at the first location on the first side of the truss using a pilot bit, the pilot hole having a first diameter that is less than a final diameter of a final hole; connecting the first pilot hole so that a pilot rod can extend from the first location to the second location through a wobbled hole; extending a pilot rod, that is coaxially connected to a borer, from the first template to the second template through the wobbled hole; placing a bushing in the first template, so that the borer is located on the centerline at the first location when the borer is located in the bushing, and the pilot rod placing the borer on the centerline of the second location when the pilot rod is located in the second template, the bushing allowing the borer to rotate and form the final hole, that is not wobbled, and has a consistent diameter in the truss.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0004] FIG. 1 is a side view of a truss structure and a metal truss connector plate.

[0005] FIG. 2 is a side view illustrating components of the present invention.

[0006] FIG. 3 is another side view illustrating components of the present invention.

[0007] FIG. 4 is an isometric view illustrating the operation of the present invention.

[0008] FIG. 5 is another isometric view illustrating components of the present invention.

[0009] FIG. 6 is an isometric view illustrating a template, bushing, and hole saw.

[0010] FIG. 7 is an isometric view illustrating two templates, a bushing, and a hole saw.

[0011] FIG. 8 is another isometric view illustrating two templates and a hole saw.

[0012] FIG. 9 is a side view illustrating the manner in which a hole saw, saws a centered hole in truss 112.

[0013] FIG. **10** is an isometric view illustrating the manner in which a hole saw, saws a hole in a truss.

[0014] FIG. **11** shows the manner in which an insert is used with an oversized hole in a truss.

[0015] FIG. **12** is an isometric view of a truss having a wobbled hole.

[0016] FIG. **13** is an isometric view of the manner in which a hole saw can be used to remove a wobbled hole.

[0017] FIG. **14** is a side view illustrating the manner in which angled templates can be used to drill holes in an angled truss.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0018] FIG. **1** illustrates a series of trusses **102**, **104**, **106**, **108** that are attached by using a metal truss connector plate **110**. An identical plate is placed on the other side of the trusses **102-108** and bolts are used to through-bolt the metal truss connector plate **110** to another identical metal truss connector plate on the other side of the trusses **102-108**. Although the system shown uses metal truss connector plates, such as metal truss connector plate **110**, to attach wooden trusses **102-108**, the process of drilling holes from one side of an object, to an exact location on another side of the object, can be used for various applications. For example, the trusses **102-108** do not necessarily need to be wooden trusses, but can be any type of material or other object. In addition, the process disclosed herein can be used to precisely bore holes from one location on one side of an object to a specified location on an opposite side of the object with a high degree of precision. In addition, the present application refers to sawing, drilling, routing, auguring, or other forms or methods of creating a hole in various types of materials. All of these techniques are referred to as “boring,” which is performed by a “bore” that can comprise a drill, an auger, a hole saw, or other similar tool. For purposes of illustration, the figures herein show a hole saw, but any desired type of bore can be used.

[0019] In order to properly drill holes in the trusses to gain maximum support, the holes must be aligned with the openings in the metal truss connector plates on each side of the trusses **102-108**. In this way, a bolt that is placed through one metal truss connector plate through the truss can then extend out of a corresponding hole in another metal truss connector plate. A tight hole in the truss, that engages a through-bolt, provides support between the metal truss connector plate **110**, trusses **102-108** and another identical plate on the other side of the trusses, since the bolt is tightly surrounded by the wood of the trusses **102-108** and aligned with the openings in the metal truss connector plate **110**. If the bolts do not fit tightly in the trusses because the holes are too big or wobbled to align with the openings in the metal truss connector plates, less structural support will be provided and movement of the trusses **102-108** may result. The metal truss connector plate **110** has twenty-four openings that require holes for bolts that must be connected directly through the twenty-four openings to a similar metal truss connector plate on the other side of the trusses **102-108**. As such, twenty-four holes must be drilled that align precisely, center-to-center with the openings in the two metal truss plates so that there is no additional space around each of the bolts in the trusses.

[0020] FIG. **2** is a side view illustrating one embodiment for boring a hole in a truss or beam **112** that fits tightly around a bolt placed through the hole. As illustrated in FIG. **2**, a drill **122** is connected to a hole saw **116** and pilot rod **114**. Templates **136**, **120** are placed on the truss **112** and secured to the truss **112**. Template **136** may comprise a metal truss connector place **110**, such as illustrated in FIG. **1**, or a metal or wood template. A pilot hole is initially drilled through truss **112**. The pilot hole may have the same diameter as the pilot rod **114** or a slightly greater diameter. Since it is difficult to drill center to center with a pilot hole, a wobbled hole **132** may be created. A wobbled hole **132** is created by drilling a hole that is smaller than the diameter of the connecting bolt **144** (FIG. **11**), i.e., a hole that is the same diameter or slightly larger diameter than the pilot rod **114**. The wobbled hole can be made by drilling the pilot bit from one side or both sides of truss **112**. A larger hole can then be bored by the hole saw **116** that exactly fits the size of the through

bolt **114**. For purposes of the explanation of FIG. 2, template **136** is a template having a pilot rod opening **128**, which is the size of the pilot rod **114**. The wobbled hole **132** is created by drilling from one side of truss **112** or by drilling halfway, or more than halfway, from each side of the truss **112** and wobbling the drill bit around until the drill bit can be passed through the template **120** and through the template **136**. The drill bit is a drill bit that has a diameter that is smaller than the diameter of the connecting bolt **144**. For purposes of describing FIG. 2, and by example only, the drill bit may constitute a $\frac{1}{4}$ " diameter drill bit. The pilot rod **114** may be a $\frac{1}{4}$ " diameter pilot rod or slightly smaller to ensure proper rotation. Pilot rod **114** is mounted co-axially with hole saw **116** in any desired fashion by bolting, welding, etc. Again, the term "hole saw" is considered to be generic for auger, borer, cutter, grinder, etc. The hole saw **116** may be a $\frac{3}{4}$ " diameter hole saw that drills a $\frac{3}{4}$ " diameter hole in the truss **112**. The bolts that are used to connect the metal truss connector plates on each side of the truss, in this example, are $\frac{3}{4}$ " bolts so that the bolts fit tightly in the hole drilled in the truss **112**. The template **136** is placed on the truss **112** so that the pilot rod opening **128** is centered on the opening of the metal truss connector plate **110** illustrated in FIG. 1. Of course, a template **136** may contain twenty-four different pilot rod openings **128**, or other number, which are centered on each of the openings in the metal truss connector plate **110**. Once the wobbled hole **132** is made large enough to fit the pilot rod **114** through the bushing **124**, through the wobbled hole to the pilot rod opening **128**, the pilot rod **114** and hole saw **116** can be rotated by the drill and pushed through the truss **112** until the hole saw **116** is aligned with an opening in the bushing **124**. Then, the hole saw **116** can be passed through the bushing **124** that has an opening that is approximately the same diameter as the hole saw **116**, with the pilot rod centered in the pilot rod opening **128**. In this manner, a hole saw **116** can saw through the truss **112**. In this example, the hole saw **116** is the same diameter as the connector bolt **144** (FIG. 11) which will be placed through the hole that is sawed in the truss **112**. In the present example, the hole saw has a diameter of $\frac{3}{4}$ " and the bolt has a diameter of $\frac{3}{4}$ ". Of course, these are only examples and various size holes, drill bits, and connector bolts can be used.

[0021] FIG. 3 is a close-up cross-sectional view of FIG. 2. As shown in FIG. 3, the bushing **124** has an opening that is the same diameter as the hole saw **128** or slightly larger to allow rotation of the hole saw **128** in bushing **124**. The bushing **124** is mounted in the template **120**, which is placed on the truss **112** so that the bushing **124** is centered on the metal truss connector plate **110** opening. The pilot rod **114** slides through the wobbled hole **132**, which was made by wobbling a drill bit on a drill through the openings on either side or both sides of the truss **112**. The pilot rod **114** slides through the truss **112** to a pilot rod opening on template **136**. The pilot rod opening **128** is centered on the location of the centerline for the opening in the metal truss connector plate **110**. Cutline **130** illustrates the manner in which the wobbled hole is removed. As is clear from FIG. 3, all of the wobbled hole **132** is removed by the hole saw **128** so that a smooth hole is created that has a uniform diameter and is centered on centerline **126**. In each example illustrated herein, the templates, such as templates **120**, **136**, are secured to the truss. The templates can be clamped in place or secured by any desired method.

[0022] FIG. 4 is an isometric view of the device of FIG. 3. As shown in FIG. 4, template **120** has a bushing **124** that is placed in the template **120**. The bushing **124** has an opening diameter that is the same diameter or slightly larger than the diameter of the hole saw **128** so that the hole saw fits through the opening in bushing **124** and can rotate easily. Template **136** is mounted on the opposite side of the truss **112**. Pilot rod **114** extends through the wobbled hole **132** and is aligned with the pilot rod opening **128** (FIG. 3) in template **136**. The hole saw passes through the opening in the bushing **124** and saws a hole in the truss **112**, in response to rotation by drill **122**. The hole saw **128** is centered on the openings of the metal truss connector plates on each side of the truss **112**.

[0023] FIG. 5 is an isometric view of FIG. 4 from an opposite side of the truss **112**. As shown in FIG. 5, the template **136** has a pilot rod opening **128**. The template **136** is placed on the truss **112** so that the pilot rod opening **128** is centered on the metal truss connector plate **110** opening, as

illustrated in FIG. 1. Multiple pilot rod openings may be provided in template 136 that are aligned with the centerline of each of the openings of the metal truss connector plate on the opposite side of truss 112 so that drill 122 can rotate hole saw 128 along the centerline of bushing 124 and pilot rod opening 128. As such, the template 136 may contain holes, e.g., twenty-four holes, such as shown in FIG. 1.

[0024] FIG. 6 is an isometric view that illustrates the hole saw 128 and pilot rod 114 extending through the bushing 124 of template 120. Drill 122 is connected to the hole saw 116 and pilot rod 114 assembly, and rotates the hole saw 128 and pilot rod 114 in the bushing 124 so that the hole saw saws a hole in the truss 112 (FIG. 5).

[0025] FIG. 7 is another isometric view of the hole saw 128 and pilot rod 114 assembly that extends through the bushing 124 in template 120 and through pilot rod opening 128 and template 136. As illustrated in FIG. 7, pilot rod 114 fits within the pilot rod opening 128 to center the pilot rod and the hole saw 128 with template 136. Bushing 124 and template 120 centers the hole saw 128, which is rotated by drill 122 in template 120.

[0026] FIG. 8 is another isometric view illustrating the manner in which the pilot rod 114 and hole saw 128 assembly fit through templates 136, 120, respectively. Pilot rod 114 extends through the pilot rod opening 128 while the hole saw 128 extends through bushing 124. Drill 122 rotates the hole saw 128 and pilot rod 114 assembly to drill a centered hole in the truss 112.

[0027] FIG. 9 illustrates an alternative embodiment of the embodiments shown in FIGS. 1-8. In accordance with the embodiment of FIG. 9, truss 112 has been drilled with a wobbled oversized hole 133 that is larger than the size of the bolt that is intended to connect metal truss connector plate 110 to a similar metal truss connector plate on the other side of the truss, as illustrated in FIG. 1. In other words, wobbled oversized hole 133, in accordance with the example given with respect to FIGS. 2 and 3, is not a wobbled hole that is made from a drill bit that is smaller than the diameter of the connector bolt 144 (FIG. 11), but rather, is an attempt to drill a full sized hole having the same diameter as the diameter of the connector bolt 144 center-to-center for the holes of the metal truss connector plates 110 and the opposite metal truss connector plate on the truss. The full size hole is not drilled on the centerline, and has been wobbled to allow the bolt to go through the openings on the two metal truss connector plates on opposite sides of the truss 112. For example, and by way of example only, if a $\frac{3}{4}$ " diameter bolt is intended to be used to connect the metal truss connector plates, the wobbled oversized hole 132 would be larger than the $\frac{3}{4}$ " diameter of the connector bolt 144. Although the $\frac{3}{4}$ " diameter bolt could be used to connect the two metal truss connector plates on each side of the truss 112, the wooden structure of the truss 112 would not be supported by the connector bolt 144. To save the truss 112, the technique illustrated in FIGS. 9-14 can be used.

[0028] As illustrated in FIG. 9, a hole saw 128, which has a diameter that is greater than the size of the wobbled oversized hole 132, and the connecting bolt 144 can be used. In that regard, in the previous example of FIGS. 1 and 2, the hole saw 128 is a $\frac{3}{4}$ " hole saw since the wobbled hole 132 was made by a smaller drill having a diameter of $\frac{1}{4}$ ". In the present example, the hole saw 128 may have a 1" diameter, since the wobbled oversized hole 132 was made by a $\frac{3}{4}$ " diameter drill bit. In the previous example of FIGS. 1 and 2, prior planning was used to drill a wobbled hole that has a smaller diameter than the diameter of the bolt to be used, i.e., $\frac{3}{4}$ " bolt. However, in the example shown in FIG. 9, there was no advanced planning and the user simply attempted to drill a full sized hole on a centerline between two metal truss connector plates on opposite sides of the truss 112. Since it is nearly impossible for the person to drill a single hole that is aligned perfectly on a centerline between the openings of metal truss connector plates on opposite sides of the truss 112, the hole must be wobbled with the full sized drill bit to create a wobbled oversized hole 132. Some contractors would simply use the wobbled oversized hole 132 and not be concerned that the truss 112 was not properly supported between the metal truss connector plates on each side of the truss 112. Using the wobbled oversized hole 132 will result in lack of structural support of the truss 112

and can lead to movement and failure of the truss structure illustrated in FIG. 1.

[0029] In order to remedy this situation, the hole saw **128**, as mentioned previously, can be a larger size, such as a 1" hole saw, that cuts a hole in the truss **112** along a centerline that aligns the openings in the metal truss connector plates on each side of the truss **112**. In other words, the same technique is used as is described in FIGS. 1-8, with the exception that a larger hole saw **128** is used to drill a larger hole, such as a 1" hole, through the truss **112**. A larger bushing **124** is used to accommodate the larger diameter hole saw **128**, so that the drill **122** can rotate the hole saw **128** in the bushing **124**. A larger pilot rod **114** can also be used, but is not necessary. Template **137** has the appropriately sized opening for the pilot rod **115**, while template **121** has an opening for the appropriate oversized bushing **125**. Again, these sizes are provided by way of example only and any appropriate size hole or bolts can be used.

[0030] FIG. **10** is an isometric view of the embodiment of FIG. **9**. As shown in FIG. **10**, the oversized hole saw **129**, which, in one example, may be a 1" diameter hole saw, fits in the oversized bushing **125** in template **121**. As mentioned above, the pilot rod **115** may be the same size as pilot rod **114** (FIGS. 1 and 2) or may be larger. An appropriately sized pilot rod opening **129** is formed in template **137**. As mentioned above with FIGS. 1 and 2, a pilot rod opening, such as pilot rod opening **127**, may constitute a plurality of openings in the template **137** that correspond to the multiple openings in metal truss connector plate **110**. Again, the wobbled hole **133** is a wobbled hole made by a drill bit that is about the same size as the connecting bolt, such as connecting bolt **144** (FIG. **11**), so that the wobbled hole **133** is larger than the connecting bolt **144**. As such, the truss **112** is not supported by the connecting bolt **144**. Oversized hole saw **129** drills a larger hole. For example, if the connecting bolt is a $\frac{3}{4}$ " diameter bolt, the oversized hole saw **129** may be a 1" diameter hole saw that drills a single hole **112** that is centered on the centerline between the openings in the metal truss connector plates on both sides of the truss **112**. The 1" diameter hole removes all of the wobbled oversized hole **133** and creates a smooth hole with a single consistent diameter that is centered between the openings in the metal truss connector plates. Oversized bushing **125** is sized to allow the oversized hole saw **129** to rotate in the oversized bushing **125** when rotated by drill **122**.

[0031] FIG. **11** is an isometric view illustrating the manner in which the oversized hole **138** can be used to center a smaller diameter connecting bolt **144** in the openings of the metal truss connector plates on both sides of the truss **112**. As illustrated in FIG. **11**, an insert **140** having an outer diameter that matches the oversized hole diameter **138** is inserted in the oversized hole **138**. The insert **140** has an opening **141** that matches the diameter of the connector bolt **144**. A washer **142** is used to allow rotation of the connector bolt **144**. Insert **140** fits tightly in the oversized hole **138** and is secured by the rounded smoothed surface of the oversized hole **138**. Connector bolt **144** fits in the opening **141** of the insert **140** with a tolerance that allows the bolt to easily turn in the opening **141**, but is not so loose as to allow substantial movement of the connector bolt **144** in the opening **141** as it transfers direction.

[0032] FIG. **12** is an isometric view of the truss **112**. As illustrated in FIG. **12**, the wobbled oversized hole **132** has a wobbled opening in the truss **112**. FIG. **12** illustrates truss **112** without the template shown that has a pilot rod opening **127** that is centered on the opening for the metal truss connector plate **110**.

[0033] FIG. **13** is an isometric view of the truss **112** that is similar to FIG. **12**, but shows the oversized hole **138** that has been sawed out around the wobbled oversized hole **132** illustrated in FIG. **12**. The oversized hole **138** has a smooth inner surface **139** with a consistent diameter in which the insert **140** (FIG. **11**) is placed. The smooth inner surface **139** engages the smooth outer surface of the insert **140**. The smooth outer surface **141** of the insert **140** (FIG. **11**) engages the smooth inner surface **139** with sufficient friction to hold the insert in place in the oversized hole **138**.

[0034] FIG. **14** illustrates another embodiment in which the present invention can be used on

angled trusses, such as angled truss **146**. As illustrated in FIG. **14**, a wobbled hole **152** is created in the angled truss **146**. The wobbled hole **152** does not provide sufficient support for a bolt that extends through each side of the angled truss **146**. Angled template **148** and angled template **150** are placed on the left side and right side, respectively, of the angled truss **146** along the centerline **156** of the openings in a metal truss connector plate (not shown). Angled template **150** has an opening **151** that allows the hole saw **160** to fit through the opening **151** and rotate in the opening **151** when turned by drill **162**. Pilot rod **158** extends through the wobbled hole **152** and through the pilot rod opening **149** in the angled template **148**. Angled template **148** and angled template **150** are secured to the surface of the angled truss **146**, as indicated above, so that the opening **151** and pilot rod opening **149** are centered on the centerline **156**. In this manner, the hole saw **160** can provide a cut indicated by cutline **154** that is centered on the centerline **156** and has the correct angle with respect to the angled truss **146**.

[0035] As shown, the present embodiments provide a process and tools for creating openings that are centered on a wooden structure, such as a wooden truss or beam, along a centerline that may connect openings in metal truss connector plates. The invention can also be used to create precise openings through a truss or other device for various other reasons when an opening must be created in wood or other material in a precise manner to connect other devices at a precise location on the other side of the material. The present invention discloses an embodiment in which a smaller hole can be used to insert a pilot rod to center a larger boring device, such as a hole saw, in the proper alignment with an opening on the opposite side of the material being bored. Alignment on one side of the material of the boring device and alignment of the pilot rod on the other side of the material results in a precisely cut opening along the centerline between the two sides of the material. In an alternative embodiment, holes can be corrected by sawing or boring a larger hole that is centered along a centerline and placing an insert in the oversized hole that has an opening of the proper size. Further, techniques are shown for using angled templates to create a hole through angled material using angled templates.

[0036] The foregoing description of the invention has been presented for purposes of illustration and description. It is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the invention to the precise form disclosed, and other modifications and variations may be possible in light of the above teachings. The embodiment was chosen and described in order to best explain the principles of the invention and its practical application to thereby enable others skilled in the art to best utilize the invention in various embodiments and various modifications as are suited to the particular use contemplated. It is intended that the appended claims be construed to include other alternative embodiments of the invention except insofar as limited by the prior art.

Claims

1. A tool for boring a final hole in a truss, having a final diameter, that is coaxial with a centerline between a first location on a first side of a truss and a second location on a second side of said truss comprising: a pilot rod that has a diameter that is less than said final diameter; a first template placed on a first side of said truss, and secured to said truss, that provides said first location on said first side of said truss; a second template placed on a second side of said truss, and secured to said truss, that provides said second location on said second side of said truss; a pilot bit secured to a drill that is adapted to create a wobbled hole in said truss between said first location and said second location that is sufficiently large to allow said pilot rod to extend through said wobbled hole from said first location to said second location; a borer mounted coaxially with said pilot rod, said borer having a diameter that is the same as said final diameter, said borer adapted to bore said final hole in said truss that is coaxial with said centerline between said first location and said second location.
2. The tool of claim 1 wherein said borer is a hole saw.

3. The tool of claim 1 wherein said borer is an auger.
 4. The tool of claim 1 wherein said borer is a bit.
 5. A method of forming a final hole in a truss that is coaxial with a centerline between a first location, on a first side of said truss, and a second location on a second side of said truss comprising: using a first template on said first side of said truss to place at least one opening in said template at said first location on said first side of said truss, and a second template on said second side of said truss to place at least one opening in said second location on said second side of said truss; drilling a first pilot hole at said first location on said first side of said truss using a pilot bit, said pilot hole having a first diameter that is less than a final diameter of a final hole; connecting said first pilot hole so that a pilot rod can extend from said first location to said second location through a wobbled hole; extending a pilot rod, that is coaxially connected to a borer, from said first template to said second template through said wobbled hole; placing a bushing in said first template, so that said borer is located on said centerline at said first location when said borer is located in said bushing, and said pilot rod placing said borer on said centerline of said second location when said pilot rod is located in said second template, said bushing allowing said borer to rotate and form said final hole, that is not wobbled, and has a consistent diameter in said truss.
 6. The method of claim 5 wherein said first diameter and said second diameter are the same.
 7. The method of claim 6 wherein said first pilot bit and said second pilot bit are the same.
 8. The method of claim 7 wherein said borer is a hole saw.
 9. The method of claim 7 wherein said borer is an auger.
 10. The method of claim 7 wherein said borer is a bit.
 11. The method of claim 5 further comprising: drilling a second pilot hole at said second location on said second side of said truss using a second pilot bit, said second pilot hole having a second diameter that is less than said final diameter of said final hole.
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